Link

USER MANUAL

Wireless remote for your hi-fi



A wireless remote for your hi-fi.

Phone, tablet and computer.

Firmware 2.3.80 · October 2026

NOTE

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01

What Link does

Link connects to your preamplifier's RS-232 control port and puts it on your home network. Any phone, tablet or computer in the house is then a remote.

```
Phone · Tablet · PC  ──Wi-Fi──▶  Link  ──RS-232──▶  Preamplifier
```

- Volume, mute, inputs, tone, outputs.
- Always in sync: turn the knob on the preamplifier and every screen follows.
- A volume limit, enforced in Link.
- No account, no cloud. Link fetches only its own updates.
- Also: subwoofers, room correction, a disc player, a music streamer's transport controls.

02

What you need

- A preamplifier with an **RS-232 control port**: a 3.5 mm jack on current models, a DB9 on a few older ones (see Compatible equipment).
- A 2.4 GHz **Wi-Fi network**.
- The free **Link app** (App Store / Google Play) for setup.
- A **USB-C charger**, 5 V, 0.5 A or more.

In the box: Link, one control cable (3.5 mm to 3.5 mm, or 3.5 mm to DB9, as chosen at order) and one USB-C cable. A further 3.5 mm device needs an ordinary stereo (TRS) cable. A DB9 cable is wired tip to pin 2, ring to pin 3, sleeve to pin 5.

03

Connect it



Rear panel

Left to right: the **control ports**, the **USB-C** power socket, the **status light**, the **button**.

1. **Control cable** from any PORT on Link to the RS-232 jack on the preamplifier. Any port; Link finds out what is plugged in where.
2. **More devices.** A second preamplifier, a B&W DB1 subwoofer, a MEN220 room-correction processor or a McIntosh MVP disc player: one cable each, into any free port.
3. **Power.** Plug in USB-C last. Link has no power switch and is meant to stay on.

NOTE

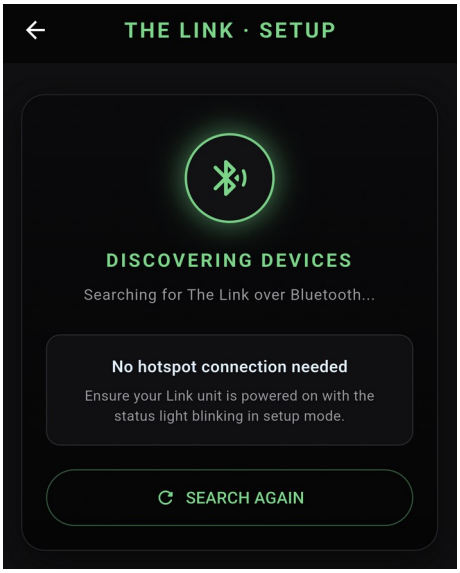
Leave the preamplifier's RS-232 baud rate at its factory setting (115200). Link finds other rates too, but slower.

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First-time setup

A new Link blinks **blue, twice, pause**. It is waiting to be set up.

With the Link app

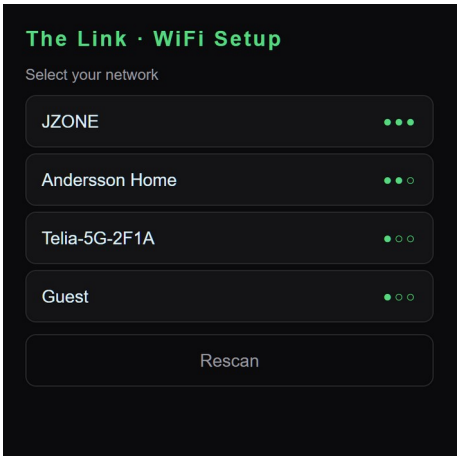


1. Install **Link** from the App Store or Google Play and open it. Allow Bluetooth; it is used only for setup.
2. The app searches over Bluetooth. Stay within a few metres of the unit.
3. It shows the Wi-Fi networks the unit can see. Pick yours and type the password. Optionally name the unit; the name becomes its address (`Studio` → `http://studio.local`).
4. Tap **Connect**. The light goes solid green and the app opens the remote.

A wrong password is reported after about a minute.

Without the app

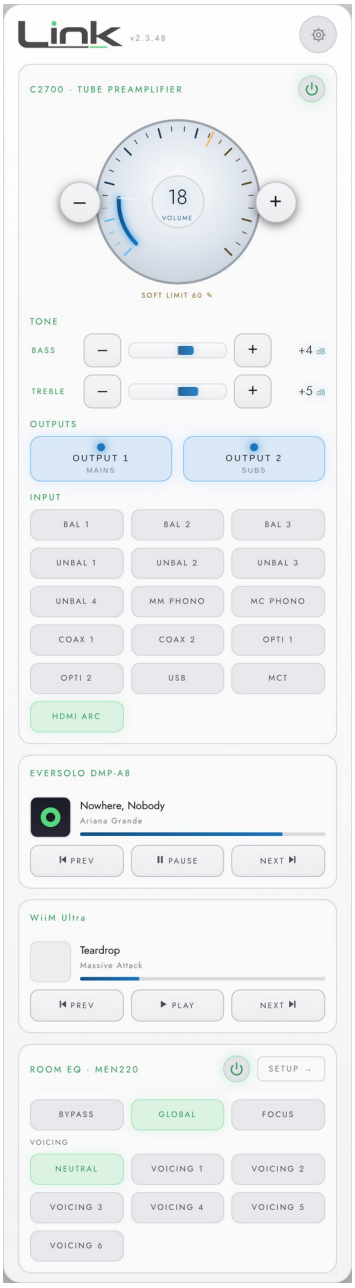
If the app says **"Can't find it?"**, or Bluetooth is unavailable:



1. Join the Wi-Fi network **`Link`**, password **`linksetup`**. Accept any "no internet" warning.
2. A setup page opens. If not, go to **`http://192.168.4.1`**.
3. Pick your network, type its password, optionally name the unit, tap **Connect**.
4. Return your device to your home Wi-Fi.

05

The remote



Open the **Link app**. It finds your Link and shows the remote.

On a computer, or without the app, open **`http://link.local`** in a browser (`http://<name>.local` if you named the unit). It is the same remote, served by Link. Chrome or Edge → address-bar menu → **Install** keeps it one click away.

Every phone, tablet and computer in the house can be open at once. They all show the same thing; Link holds the state.

The main screen

One screen. Each piece of equipment has its own card.

The preamplifier card

Power — the ⏻ button in the card header. Tube preamplifiers take about 15 seconds to warm up.

Volume — the dial. Tap **+** and **–**; hold to run. On a computer, the scroll wheel over the dial or the arrow keys. **Tap the number in the middle to mute.** There is no drag and no tap-on-dial: volume moves one step at a time.

Soft limit — the line under the dial. See Volume safety.

Tone — bass and treble, ±12 dB. Tap **TONE** to switch the tone controls in and out. The preamplifier stores tone per input. Models without tone controls hide the section.

Surround — A/V receivers and processors only (AUTO / THROUGH / MOVIE / MUSIC / GAME).

Outputs — OUTPUT 1 and OUTPUT 2. Rename them in Panel Setup.

Inputs — a button per input. Hide and rename them in Panel Setup.

The streamer cards

Link finds Eversolo, WiiM, BluOS (Bluesound, NAD, DALI, PSB), Denon and Marantz HEOS, OpenHome (Linn, Lumin, Auralic), Cambridge Audio and other UPnP/DLNA players on your network. Each gets a card: cover art, title, artist, a progress bar you can tap to seek, **PREV · PLAY · NEXT**.

What a card can do depends on the player and its current source: a HEOS speaker has no progress bar, internet radio may not allow skipping back, generic UPnP/DLNA players may show little track information.

SHOW ON PANEL on a streamer's page hides that card. **REMOVE** drops the player. Televisions are never listed.

Link does not control the streamer's volume. The preamplifier owns volume.

The disc player card

Shown when a McIntosh **MVP861**, **MVP871** or **MVP901** is connected to a port: state, track, **PREV · STOP · PLAY/PAUSE · NEXT**, power.

The room-correction card

Shown when a McIntosh MEN220 is connected. See section 8.

Several preamplifiers

Up to four preamp-class devices at once, by port or over the network. With two or more, tabs appear at the top. Each has its own volume, limit, names and safety.

Themes

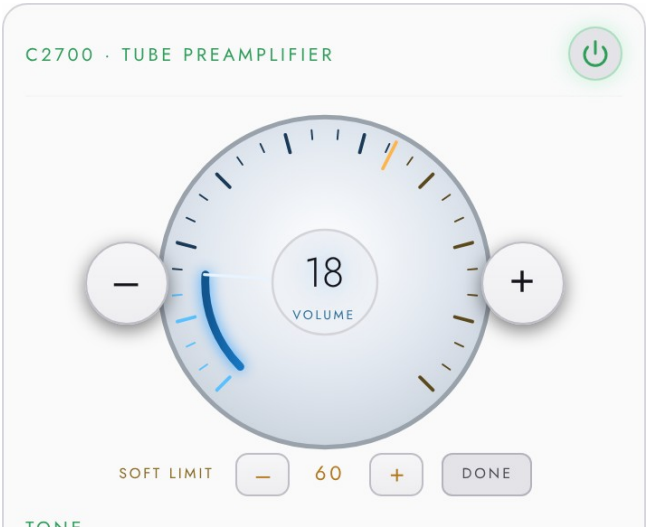
DARK, LIGHT, GRAPHITE, SILVER, CLASSIC and STUDIO, under **Panel Setup → SYSTEM → THEME**. Per phone or browser. This manual uses LIGHT.

06

Volume safety

Link never sends an absolute volume. Only "one step up" or "one step down", each confirmed by the preamplifier before the next. No glitch, stale screen or lost connection can produce a jump.

The soft limit is a ceiling. Under the dial: `SOFT LIMIT 60` ✎. Tap it, adjust with **–** / **+**, tap **DONE**. Volume-up is dropped at the ceiling. It is enforced in Link, so it holds for every phone.



Editing the soft limit

To go above the limit, reach it; **UNLOCK >60** appears under the dial. Tap it. After 30 seconds the ceiling is back.

Lowering the limit below the current volume steps the volume down to meet it.

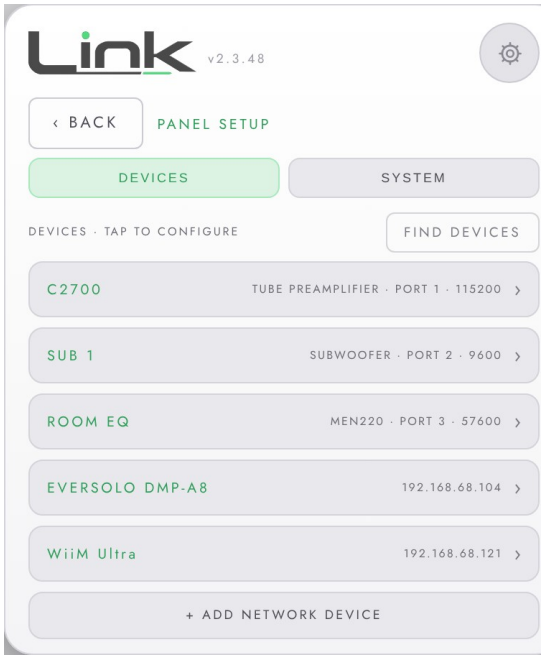
Always on: a minimum interval between steps; hold-to-repeat is the app sending single steps, so a lost connection stops the volume at once; the screen shows only what the preamplifier has confirmed.

> **NOTE**
> Set the limit before you need it.

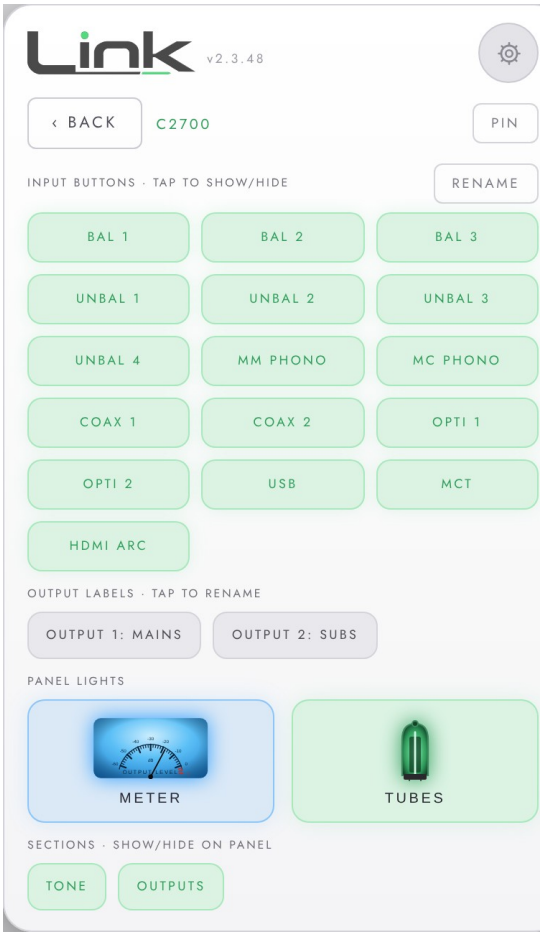
07

Panel Setup

☰ top right, then **SETTINGS**. Two tabs: **DEVICES** and **SYSTEM**. The menu also has FIND DEVICES, THEME, CHECK FOR UPDATE, REARRANGE CARDS and ABOUT.



Panel Setup — devices



A preamplifier's own settings page

DEVICES

What Link has found, with port and speed. Tap a row for that device's settings. Ports still searching are listed dimmed as "PORT n — scanning...".

FIND DEVICES looks again: empty ports, streamers, supported preamplifiers on the network. It never removes a wired device; one that has stopped answering stays listed as lost.

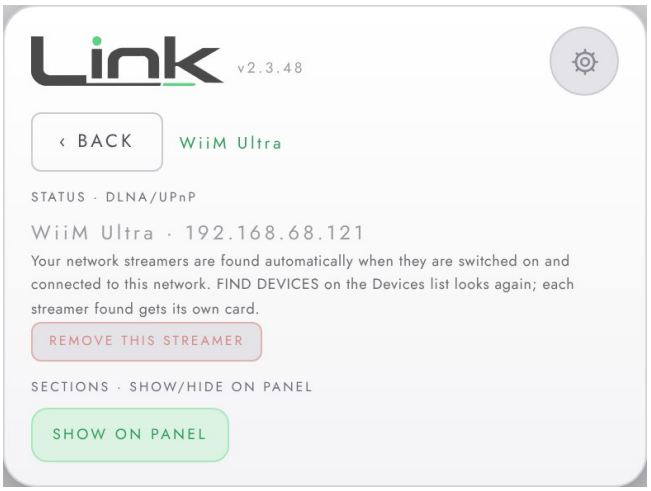
A preamplifier's page:

- **INPUT BUTTONS** — tap to show or hide; **RENAME** to relabel.
- **OUTPUT LABELS** — tap to rename.
- **PANEL LIGHTS** — METER and TUBES, where the model has them.

- **PREAMP SETTINGS** — the preamplifier's own trim menu: balance, input trim, mono, display brightness, headphone HXD, phono loads (while a phono input is selected), and on models that have them phono gain, processor loop, output 1 trim and dual mono. Output 1 mode and crossover are shown for reference; set them on the preamplifier. Only what the model reports is listed. Stored in the preamplifier, per input; the heading names the input.
- **SECTIONS** — show or hide TONE and OUTPUTS on the main screen.

The layout is stored in Link, per model, so every phone sees the same and a device keeps its names and limit when moved to another port.

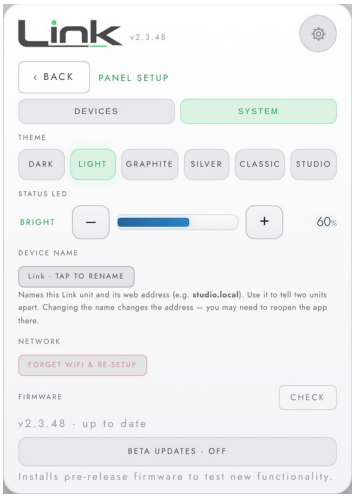
A streamer's page: name and address; **SHOW ON PANEL**; **OPEN WITH**, the app its card opens (on Android, any app on the phone; on iPhone, a list of music apps; stored per phone); **REMOVE THIS STREAMER**.



A streamer's settings page

+ ADD NETWORK DEVICE — see section 9.

SYSTEM



- **THEME**
- **STATUS LED** — brightness of the light on the box.
- **DEVICE NAME** — names the unit and sets its address. Use it to tell two units apart.
- **NETWORK** — **FORGET WIFI & RE-SETUP**.
- **FIRMWARE** — the running version; **CHECK** for updates. See section 11.
- **BETA UPDATES** — pre-release versions. Off by default.

Pinning a setting to the main screen

Any setting on a device page can be placed in a **PINNED** card on the main screen.

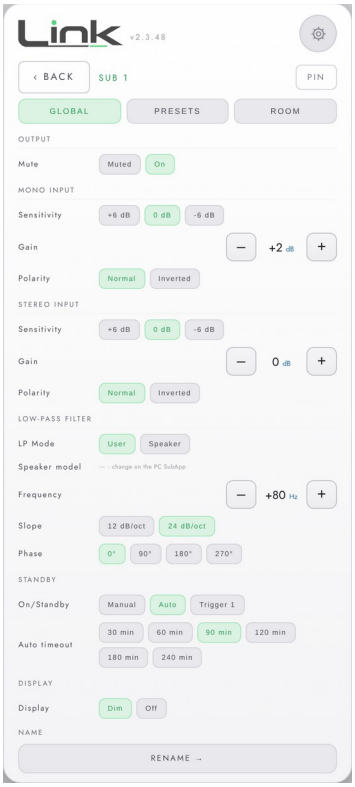
1. Open the device's page and tap **PIN** in its header.
2. Tap the setting. While PIN is on, a tap pins instead of changing.
3. Tap **PIN** again.

Press and hold a setting to pin or unpin it directly. Pins are stored in Link.

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Subwoofers and room correction

Subwoofers. Two **B&W DB1** subwoofers, one cable each into any free port. They appear in **Panel Setup → DEVICES** with the settings of the manufacturer's own app: gain, sensitivity, polarity, low-pass filter, standby, presets, mute, rename.



Room measurement stays on a PC; it needs the manufacturer's microphone.

Room correction. A McIntosh **MEN220** appears as a **ROOM EQ** card:



Room EQ card

- **Correction mode** — Bypass, Global, or a Focus position.
- **Voicing** — Neutral plus six.
- Power, focus position and rename on its **SETUP** page.

Focus positions are measured with the processor's own setup. Link selects between them.

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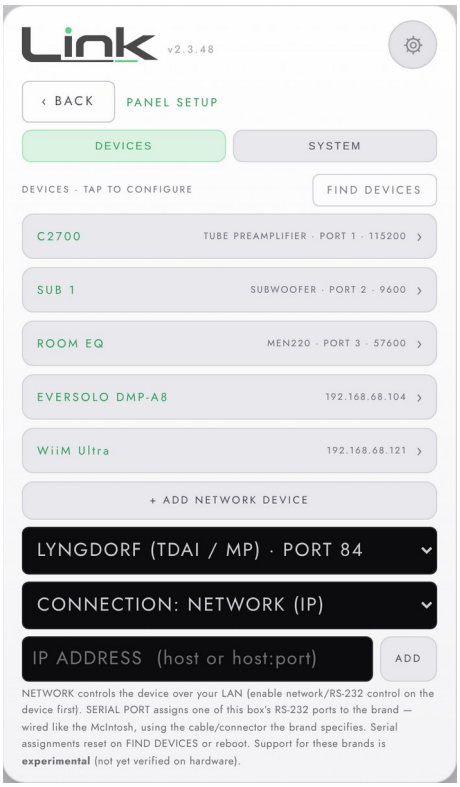
Adding other brands

Preamplifiers, integrated amplifiers and processors from **Lyngdorf, Rotel/Michi, Denon/Marantz, NAD, Yamaha, Onkyo/Integra, Audio Research, Arcam, Anthem, Mark Levinson, Primare, Meridian, Trinnov/JBL Synthesis, Krell** and **Classé**, over the network or wired to a port.

Link looks for them by itself: after start-up, when the remote is idle, and on **FIND DEVICES**. A receiver that is also a network player (Denon, Marantz, Yamaha, Onkyo, Integra, Arcam, Lyngdorf) is added as a preamplifier beside its streamer card. A removed network device is not added again by itself.

Panel Setup → DEVICES → + ADD NETWORK DEVICE is for a device the search does not reach, for example one that ignores ping or sits on another network:

1. Pick the brand.
2. Pick the connection: NETWORK, or one of Link's ports.
3. For a network device, type its IP address (`:port` only if changed from the brand default). Tap **ADD**.

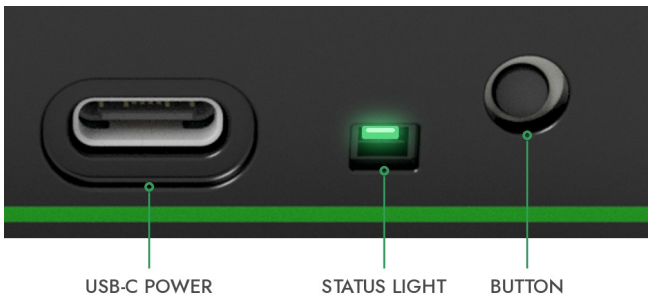


Notes:

- Enable network control ("IP control", "network standby") on the device, or it stops answering when it sleeps.
- Volume is relative-only and limit-protected on every brand, as in section 6. The dial uses the brand's own scale.
- Port assignments reset on reboot; network devices are remembered.
- These brands are **experimental**: written from the manufacturers' control documentation, not yet verified on a real unit. Try at low volume first.

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The button and the light



Button and status light

The button

PRESS	DOES
Short press	**Sleep.** Light out, radio off. Press again to wake.
Hold 5 seconds	**Factory reset.** The light flashes red; at 5 s it goes dark. Let go.

NOTE
Asleep, Link is off the network and the app cannot wake it. Only the button can.

A factory reset erases everything in Link (Wi-Fi, names, limits, layout) and reopens setup mode. It does not touch the preamplifier's own settings. Releasing before five seconds is a sleep press, not a reset.

The status light

RHYTHM	COLOUR	MEANING
Solid	green	On the network, talking to the equipment
Slow breathe	amber	On the network, equipment not answering. Check the cable.
Fast breathe	amber	Cannot join the saved Wi-Fi
Two quick blinks, pause	blue	Setup mode
Fast flashing	red	Button held. Let go to cancel.
Off	—	Asleep, or no power

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Updates

Link checks about once a day and installs new versions while the remote is idle. If one is waiting when you open the app, the FIRMWARE line in **Panel Setup → SYSTEM** shows **UPDATE**; tap to install now.

- Updates are signed and verified in Link before installing.
- An update takes about 20 seconds. The music keeps playing; the volume cannot be changed from the phone meanwhile. The page reloads itself.
- A version that misbehaves is rolled back by Link.
- **BETA UPDATES** (Panel Setup → SYSTEM) also receives pre-release versions. Switching it off keeps the current version until the next regular release overtakes it.
- The app may show *"A new version of the app is available — RELOAD"*. Tap RELOAD.

Updates are the only thing Link fetches from the internet.

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Keyboard shortcuts

On a computer, with the remote in focus:

KEY	DOES
↑ / ↓	Volume up / down (hold to repeat)
Scroll wheel over the dial	Volume
M	Mute
1 – 6	Input 1 to 6
Space	Play / pause the streamer
N / P	Next / previous track

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Troubleshooting

The app says NO LINK NEARBY. Blue blinking: setup mode, follow section 4. Solid green: already on a network; tap **ENTER AN ADDRESS** and type `link.local`. Dark: asleep; press the button. Amber breathing: cannot reach its saved network; hold the button until the light goes dark and set it up again.

`link.local` doesn't open. Some Android and older Windows versions cannot resolve `.local` names. Find `link` (or your name for it) in the router's device list and use its IP address. A named unit is at the name in lowercase, spaces as hyphens: `Living Room` → `http://living-room.local`.

The app opens but is not connected to the equipment. Check the control cable at both ends and that the preamplifier is on. Then **Panel Setup → DEVICES → FIND DEVICES**.

Volume won't go higher. The soft limit. Tap **UNLOCK** under the dial, or raise the limit.

An input reports an error when selected. It is switched Off in the preamplifier's setup menu. Enable it there, or hide it in Panel Setup.

A streamer or network receiver isn't found. Switch it on, on the same network as Link, then **FIND DEVICES**. Guest networks and separate segments block the search; a supported receiver can be added by hand with **+ ADD NETWORK DEVICE**.

Two units clash. Every unit answers to `link.local` until it is named. Name one in **Panel Setup → SYSTEM → DEVICE NAME**. It moves to its own address and leaves `link.local` to the other.

Starting over. Panel Setup → SYSTEM → FORGET WIFI & RE-SETUP, or hold the button until the light goes dark.

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Compatible equipment

Link works with equipment that has an RS-232 control port with a selectable baud rate. It detects the model by itself and adapts the screen to it.

McIntosh preamplifiers	C2500, C2600, C2700, C2800, C47, C48, C49, C50, C52, C53, C55, C1100, C12000
McIntosh integrated amplifiers	MA5300, MA352, MA7200, MA8900, MA8950, MA9000, MA9500, MA12000
McIntosh processors / receivers	MHT300, MX100, MX200
McIntosh digital preamplifier	D1100
McIntosh disc players	MVP861, MVP871, MVP901 (transport and power)
DB9 port (choose the DB9 cable when ordering)	C48, C50, C2500, MEN220, MVP861, MVP871, MVP901, B&W DB1. All others have the 3.5 mm jack.
Other brands (experimental)	Lyngdorf, Rotel/Michi, Denon/Marantz, NAD, Yamaha, Onkyo/Integra, Audio Research, Arcam, Anthem, Mark Levinson, Primare, Meridian, Trinnov/JBL Synthesis, Krell, Classé

Also: B&W DB1 subwoofers · McIntosh MEN220 room correction · Eversolo, WiiM and BluOS streamers (full) · Denon and Marantz HEOS, OpenHome (Linn, Lumin, Auralic) and Cambridge Audio players (now playing and transport) · other UPnP/DLNA players (transport).

Not supported: equipment with only a Data Port, an IR input or trigger outputs, such as the McIntosh C2200, C2300, MA7000 and the MVP831, MVP841 and MVP851. These are one-way connections. Link does not use infrared.

A receiver or processor with a **volume scale** setting: leave it on the linear 0–99 scale.

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Care, power and specifications

Ports	3 × 3.5 mm TRS, RS-232
Network	Wi-Fi 2.4 GHz, Bluetooth LE (setup only)
Power	USB-C, 5 V, 0.5 A minimum (cable included, charger not)
Cooling	Passive, silent
Enclosure	Compact desktop box

No user-serviceable parts. Keep it in open air, not in a sealed cabinet or on a warm component. Wipe with a dry cloth.

Support

info@playandtrack.com

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